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Youth gamble: Chennai Super Kings made a bold statement at the mini-auction, splurging a record Rs. 14.20 crore each on uncapped youngsters Kartik Sharma (left) and Prashant Veer (right), betting big on raw Indian promise.

rather than established names.

Uttar Pradesh all-rounder Prashant Veer and Rajasthan wicketkeeper-batter Kartik Sharma were the biggest beneficiaries, with both landing Rs. 14.2 crore deals, the highest ever paid for uncapped players in IPL auction history.

"As the game evolved, we may have been slow to evolve with it," CSK coach Stephen Fleming admitted midway through the auction. "Halfway through [the 2025] tournament, we made a big shift. We identified that we needed to change."

On paper, Prashant, a 20-year-old lower-order batter who bowls

left-arm spin, looks like a long-term replacement for Ravindra Jadeja, who was traded to Rajasthan Royals for Sanju Samson.

Kartik's signing, however, creates a problem of plenty. The 19-year-old power-hitter becomes CSK's fourth wicketkeeper, alongside Samson, Urvil, and MS Dhoni.

Domestic pacers in demand

The other major uncapped windfall went to Jammu & Kashmir pacer Auqib Nabi, snapped up by Delhi Capitals for Rs. 8.4 crore. A consistent performer in domestic red-ball cricket, the 29-year-old has recently

sharpened his death-bowling skills, earning him a maiden IPL contract.

Defending champion Royal Challengers Bengaluru also chased domestic pace, signing left-arm quick Mangesh Yadav for Rs. 5.20 crore, making him its second-most expensive buy behind all-rounder Venkatesh Iyer (Rs. 7 crore).

Big reputations, little interest

The scramble for domestic talent coincided with a cautious approach towards overseas players, particularly early in the auction. Liam Livingstone, Jake Fraser-McGurk, and Devon Conway all went unsold initially.